

Chapter 111-1

Chen Mian.

This name had been frequently mentioned since last night, so Liang Shi naturally knew it.

However, she didn't know if the Chen Mian that Gu Xingyue was referring to was the same person Liang Wanwan had been talking about yesterday.

Liang Shi paused for a moment before answering, "I know one—she was my art studio classmate in middle school."

"Then let's talk when we meet." Gu Xingyue said and quickly hung up the phone.

Liang Shi drove to Gulang Pavilion.

This was a highly private tea house where many people came to discuss matters.

It was just past noon, and there weren't many people in the tea house.

As soon as she entered, she was surrounded by the lingering fragrance of tea, refreshing and pleasant. A server proactively came forward to ask, "Do you have a reservation?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "I don't know."

She called Gu Xingyue, but the other party didn't answer.

Liang Shi's heart was pounding with nervousness, somewhat afraid that it was Yang Jiani who had made Gu Xingyue call her.

But Yang Jiani had no motive to do such a thing. Even if she found out about Liang Shi's contact with Gu Xingyue, what could she do?

Even Zhou Yi'an's father couldn't cover the sky with one hand¹, so what could she possibly do?

Liang Shi was only worried that Gu Xingyue had fallen into danger.

Just as she was hesitating whether to call Gu Xingyue again, she received a text message:
【1007.】

Just four numbers. She thought for a moment and asked the server, "Do you have a private room 1007 here?"

"Yes, miss." The server said as she led her there.

Liang Shi stood at the door of room 1007, curled her fingers and knocked three times. The door opened from inside.

It was Gu Xingyue.

She was still wearing a light yellow long dress with a cardigan over it. Her hair was tied up with a blue scrunchie², and her makeup was fresh and elegant.

She looked gentle and serene.

This was her usual attire.

In the past, whenever Liang Shi saw Gu Xingyue dressed this way, she always felt that the temperament emanating from her bones matched this style of dress, making it appear particularly harmonious.

It also suited her face perfectly.

But today, Liang Shi had a strong feeling that Gu Xingyue shouldn't be like this.

She was gentle, yes, but there was a resilient toughness deep in her bones.

If the Qi Jiao in her memories was like hot spring water, then Gu Xingyue was flowing water.

Sometimes like a stream, sometimes like a waterfall.

But now Yang Jiani only gave her the opportunity to be a stream.

So she had suppressed her waterfall nature.

Yet once given the chance, the waterfall would surely cascade down with tremendous force.

Gu Xingyue was merely playing the role of Qi Jiao.

So this was probably the style of dress that Yang Jiani liked.

All of Gu Xingyue's emotions were hidden away. She sat kneeling on a cushion, and on the natural wood-colored table sat two cups of hot tea. The blue-green porcelain cups were pleasing to the eye.

But inexplicably, Liang Shi sensed a trace of tension.

Liang Shi sat across from Gu Xingyue and found her sitting there in a daze, her eyes staring at some unknown spot on the table, devoid of any sparkle.

Liang Shi didn't speak either, waiting for her to come back to herself, and instead picked up the teacup and took a small sip.

A few seconds later, Gu Xingyue's eyes moved as she came back to her senses. Upon seeing Liang Shi, she let out a light breath and, without any unnecessary words, went straight to the point. "This is Qi Jiao's complete diary."

Gu Xingyue handed over a notebook—it was a fairly new diary.

"As you've seen, all her diary entries were written in Morse code because she was afraid Yang Jiani would see them." When Gu Xingyue said this, she suddenly pressed her lips together, lowered her eyes to look at the teacup on the table, and as if somewhat nervous, picked up the cup and drank it all in one gulp.

A tea leaf still clung to the corner of her mouth.

After drinking, she took a piece of paper to wipe the water stains from her lips, then picked up the tea leaf and placed it on the table. Then she said in a deep voice, "I forgot to introduce myself to you."

Gu Xingyue looked at her, and in those eyes were indifference and fearlessness, different from before.

There was a feeling of having seen through life and death.

After not seeing her for a while, Gu Xingyue had acquired a bit more coldness.

"My name is Gu Xingyue." Gu Xingyue smiled slightly. "You should know by now—I grew up in Angel Orphanage, and my current name is Qi Jiao. I've been living under Qi Jiao's name for..."

She paused, then shook her head with a bitter smile. "I can't remember clearly anymore."

She had already lost any feeling about it.

Yesterday and today were no different; it was the same environment, the same feelings.

The same hardship to endure.

She really couldn't remember clearly anymore. Anyway, she must have been Qi Jiao for many, many years now. No one had called her Yueyue³ anymore.

No one had called out her name—Gu Xingyue!

The only name she was known by was Qi Jiao.

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1. "Cover the sky with one hand" (只手遮天) is a Chinese idiom meaning to monopolize power and deceive everyone, or to have absolute control over a situation. ⇐
 2. The original Chinese term "大腸圈" literally translates to "intestine ring," which is a colloquial term for a scrunchie—a fabric-covered elastic hair tie that has a gathered, ruched appearance. ⇐
 3. "Yueyue" (月月) is an affectionate nickname derived from the "月" (moon/month) character in Gu Xingyue's name. In Chinese, it's common to create nicknames by repeating a character from someone's name. ⇐